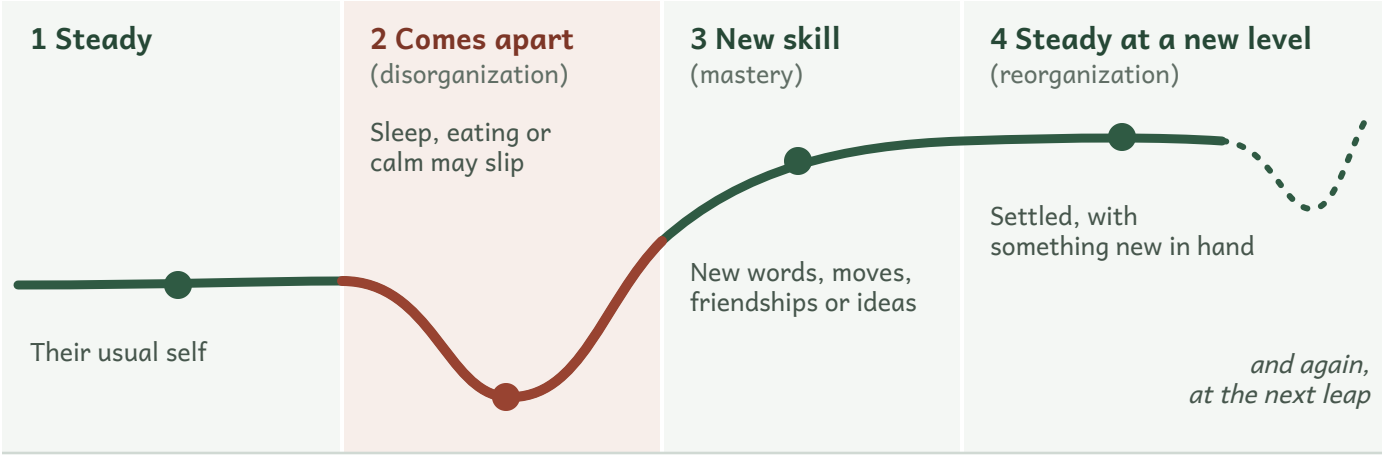
Fulton Community School

Before your child grows into something new

For	Ages	Drawn from
Families	**Two to five**	**Brazelton's Touchpoints**

Children grow in spurts. Many come apart for a while just before a new skill.

The path



Why it happens

Energy goes to the new skill
Learning something new takes so much effort that sleep, eating or calm can slip.

Old ways are reorganizing
What worked before no longer fits, and new ways are still forming.

It passes
Coming apart is usually temporary, and new growth follows.

Leaps you may see from two to five

- Talking in longer sentences
- Making and keeping friends
- Reading others' feelings
- Using the toilet on their own
- Pretend play and storytelling
- New ways of moving
- Big new ideas, and new fears
- Doing more for themselves

Adapted from T. Berry Brazelton and Joshua Sparrow, The Touchpoints Model of Development (2003), Touchpoints Birth to Three and Touchpoints Three to Six.

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Before your child grows into something new

You may see

- A skill seems to slip
- Changes in sleep, eating or toileting
- Harder goodbyes
- More no's and bigger feelings

What helps

- **Extra closeness** and time together
- **Steady routines** at home
- **Calm, kind limits.** Children still need them
- **Patience** with yourself and your child
- **Watch for the new skill** and enjoy it together

Together

- You know your child best
- Tell us what you see at home
- We share what we see at school
- Mixed feelings are part of parenting

When to talk with us

The changes go on for a long time. A skill is lost and nothing new seems to be coming. Anything worries you. We are glad to talk.

Adapted from T. Berry Brazelton and Joshua Sparrow, The Touchpoints Model of Development (2003), Touchpoints Birth to Three and Touchpoints Three to Six.